"Need more women to believe in their capabilities"

Vishakha Mulye, MD and CEO of Aditya Birla Capital, on leadership, key learnings from her experience, growth drivers for Aditya Birla Capital and addressing diversity

BY **NACHIKET KELKAR**

"It may sound trivial, but whether to attend my child's PTA meeting in school or an important meeting in office has been among the toughest decisions I have had to take," Vishakya Mulye, the MD and CEO of Aditya Birla Capital, tells *Business Today* during an interview.

Mulye is a well-known figure in the financial services space, having worked in two large institutions—ICICI Group and Aditya Birla Capital.

Many women would have gone through the same dilemma in their careers. While Mulye sees clear improvement for women in the corporate world and an increasing presence in leadership positions, she also feels many more need encouragement, support, and confidence to stay the course.

Mulye, who has ranked eighth in the listed universe in the *BT* Most Powerful Women 2026 ranking, has spent three decades working across banking, insurance, and private equity at ICICI Group, and was involved in major milestones like the merger of ICICI and ICICI Bank. She has been able to leverage those learnings as she leads Aditya Birla Capital which, under her leadership, has emerged among the top five diversified NBFCs in India. Edited excerpts:

Q: You have been a career banker and have played a key role within Aditya Birla Group as well as earlier at ICICI. How has that shaped your life and what have been the learnings?

A: I have been extremely fortunate to work with two large organisations—ICICI Group and Aditya Birla Group, which have played an important role in shaping India's business landscape.

I spent almost 30 years at ICICI. I started as a management trainee and got the opportunity to work with some great mentors and leaders who shaped my thinking. I joined ICICI in 1993, when the financial